

Assessment-Embedded Lesson Plans: The Relationship Between Learning Objectives, Learning Targets, Success Criteria, and Formative Assessment

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Assessment-Embedded Lesson Plans

1. INTRODUCTION

A teacher wants students to learn. Good teachers check learning during the lesson. They do not wait for the end. This is called an assessment-embedded lesson plan.

2. MEANING OF LESSON PLAN

Lesson plan means a written plan for one lesson. It has these main parts.

- Aim of the lesson
- Work for students to do
- Things like books and charts
- Ways to check learning

3. KEY TERMS

This topic has four key terms. They are objective, target, success criteria and formative assessment.

3.1 Learning Objective

Learning objective means the aim of the lesson. The teacher takes it from the textbook. It uses action words like name, explain and solve (Bloom, 1956). It answers the question "What will students learn?"

Example: Students will name plant parts.

3.2 Learning Target

Learning target means the objective in easy words for students. It is only for today's lesson. It starts with "I can" (Moss & Brookhart, 2012). It answers the question "What can I do today?"

Example: I can name four plant parts.

3.3 Success Criteria

Success criteria means signs that show the target is reached. They answer the question "How will I know?" (Hattie, 2012).

Example: I can label a plant picture.

3.4 Formative Assessment

Formative assessment means checking learning during the lesson. Feedback means telling students how to do better. The teacher gives feedback. The teacher changes teaching if needed.

Formative assessment is for learning, not for marks (Black & Wiliam, 1998). It answers the question "Did students learn?"

Example: The teacher asks questions while teaching.

4. ASSESSMENT-EMBEDDED LESSON PLAN

Assessment means checking learning. Embedded means put inside. Assessment-embedded lesson plan means a plan with checks inside. There is a check in every step.

The checks are not only at the end. The teacher plans these checks before the lesson (Wiliam, 2011). So the teacher knows who is learning. The teacher also knows who needs help.

5. RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN THE FOUR KEY TERMS

The four key terms are linked like a chain. Each term leads to the next term.

- Step 1: Learning objective tells the aim.
- Step 2: Learning target makes the aim simple.
- Step 3: Success criteria show signs of learning.
- Step 4: Formative assessment checks the learning.

Table 1: The Four Key Terms and Their Questions

Key Term	Question It Answers	Example
Learning Objective	What will students learn?	Students will name plant parts
Learning Target	What can I do today?	I can name four plant parts
Success Criteria	How will I know?	I can label a plant picture
Formative Assessment	Did students learn?	Teacher asks questions and helps

6. WAYS OF FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT

Formative assessment has many easy ways. One way is an exit slip. Exit slip means a small paper with one question.

- Asking questions: teacher asks, students answer.
- Thumbs up or down: students show understanding.
- Exit slip: one question at the end.
- Small board or slate: students show answers.
- Pair talk: two students share answers.

7. SAMPLE LESSON PLAN

This is a sample plan for Grade 4 Science. The topic is Parts of a Plant. The time is 40 minutes.

- Objective: Students will name plant parts.
- Target: I can name four plant parts.
- Success criteria: I can label a plant picture.

Table 2: Sample Assessment-Embedded Lesson Plan

Step	Teacher Does	How Teacher Checks
Start (5 min)	Shows a plant and tells the target	Students read the target aloud
Teach (15 min)	Teaches root, stem, leaf and flower	Asks questions while teaching
Practice (10 min)	Asks students to draw a plant	Students label parts on slates
Check (5 min)	Asks, then teaches again if needed	Thumbs up or down
End (5 min)	Gives a small paper with one question	Exit slip: name four parts

8. BENEFITS

An assessment-embedded lesson plan has many benefits. Benefits means good points.

- Students know what to learn.
- Students know how to check themselves.
- Teacher finds problems early.
- Weak students get help on time.
- Teaching gets better every day.

9. CONCLUSION

The four key terms make one chain. Objective leads to target. Target leads to success criteria.

Success criteria lead to formative assessment. So an assessment-embedded lesson plan helps every student learn.

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